

SIH Winners: Quick Analysis (2023–2025)

I looked at a few winning projects from the last 3 SIH editions to see what they did differently and what we can take from them for SIH 2026.

2023

Cryptonite – MIT Manipal: AI-based anti-phishing tool. They focused on real-time protection and made it more like an actual usable product instead of just an ML model.

Lingua_Masters – MAIT: English-to-Hindi translation tool for government websites. They followed the exact use case in the PS instead of making a generic translator.

Main takeaway: Solve the actual PS and make the solution usable.

2024

CTRL K: AI/ML system for predicting agricultural commodity prices. The prediction was meant to help with real decisions, not just show model accuracy.

Hacktivists_24: Used data collection, ML analysis and a dashboard for identifying suspicious social-media activity. It was an end-to-end system.

Main takeaway: AI should have a purpose and should lead to something useful.

2025

Enigmaa – IIIT Allahabad: AI-based railway rake planning/optimisation. Instead of only predicting something, the system helped with decision-making.

Eklavya – MITAOE: AI-based timetable generation. They handled real constraints like rooms, faculty, batches and conflicts.

Main takeaway: A practical decision-making/optimisation system can be stronger than a basic AI demo.

What I noticed overall

Winning teams usually...	So we should...
Understand the PS properly	Not force a random idea into it
Build a working prototype	Get the basic version working first
Use AI only when useful	Not add AI just because it's SIH
Think about real users	Show who will actually use it
Have some novelty	Clearly explain what makes ours different
Think beyond the demo	Mention scalability and future use

My main takeaway: We don't need the most complicated tech stack. We need to understand the problem properly, build something that actually works, make it different enough, and show why it would be useful in real life.